FUTURE SCENARIO

From Challenge to Tested Concept

A hypothetical end-of-workshop story showing how we could move from a broad banking challenge to a testable concept and a validation plan.

Mass-affluent working segment: ~$100k-$1M investable assets

Illustrative future scenario - research findings and test results are hypothetical.

Purpose: demonstrate the process, not claim a finished product or validated business case.

5-DAY WORKSHOP

1. Understand
2. Empathize
3. Define
4. Ideate
5. **Prototype + Test**

Phase 1 - Understand

DAY 1

We aligned on the problem space before discussing solutions.

What we did

We clarified the challenge: keep customers informed, engaged and supported in financial decisions.

We used ~$100k-$1M investable assets as a working mass-affluent definition, not a universal rule.

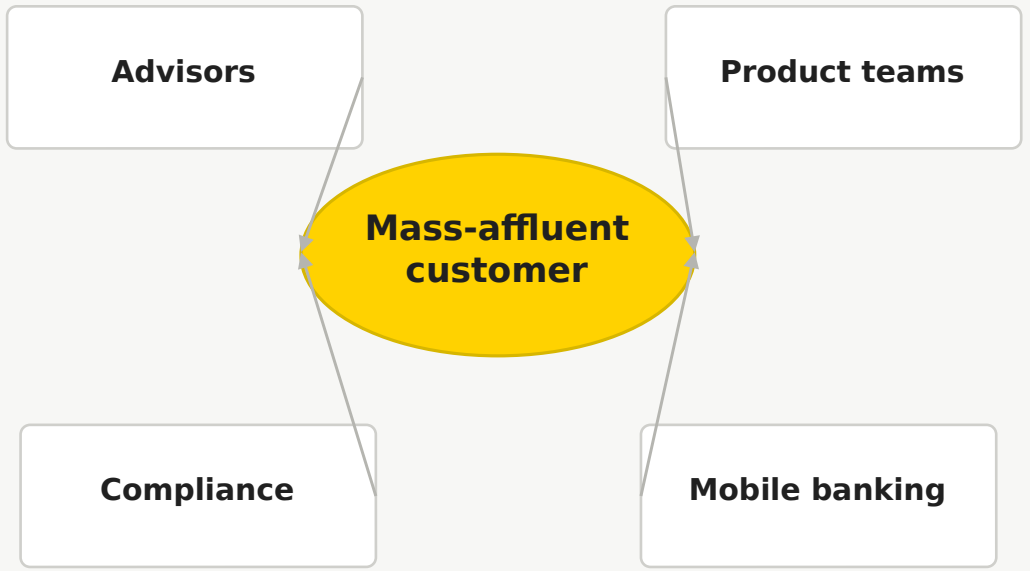
We agreed that existing banks already offer premium tiers, digital investing and advisor access.

We framed the opportunity around continuity, relevance, simplicity and accessible support.

We separated what we knew from what still needed validation.

We aligned business goals with customer outcomes without choosing a solution.

STAKEHOLDER MAP



OUTPUT **A shared challenge statement + a visible assumptions list.**

UNDERSTAND | EMPATHIZE | DEFINE | IDEATE | PROTOTYPE & TEST

Phase 2 - Empathize and Sensitize

DAY 2

We looked for customer context without pretending that limited workshop evidence was full validation.

How we learned

We reviewed available secondary research.
We used proxy conversations with advisors or relationship managers.
We sought direct customer conversations where available.
We focused on recent real decisions, not abstract preferences.
We tagged every insight as evidence, proxy insight or assumption.

ILLUSTRATIVE PERSONA - NOT VALIDATED

“Mira”, 44

Has meaningful savings, little time, modest investment confidence, and is cautious about product-led advice.

COMPACT EMPATHY MAP

THINKS

“I should do more with my savings, but what fits my goals?”

FEELS

Cautious; wants clarity without being rushed.

SAYS

“Explain the trade-offs in plain language.”

DOES

Reads, compares, delays, and asks a trusted person.

EVIDENCE | PROXY INSIGHT | ASSUMPTION

We kept these categories separate when prioritizing needs and journey pain points.

OUTPUT **Prioritized needs and pains + a short customer journey, with evidence strength visible.**

UNDERSTAND | **EMPATHIZE** | DEFINE | IDEATE | PROTOTYPE & TEST

Phase 3 - Define

DAY 2-3

We turned scattered observations into one problem to explore - without choosing the solution.

How we converged

We clustered observations by recurring need, friction and journey moment.

We checked which patterns were supported by stronger evidence and which were still assumptions.

We selected one customer problem that was meaningful, narrow enough to test and relevant to the bank.

We wrote a provisional problem statement.

We reframed it as a How Might We question to open the solution space.

We proposed success criteria before ideation.

PROVISIONAL PROBLEM STATEMENT

“Mass-affluent customers who want to put their savings to work may struggle to find clear, trusted guidance suited to their goals, causing them to delay decisions or seek support elsewhere.”

HOW MIGHT WE?

How might we help mass-affluent customers make informed, confident financial decisions with accessible support from their bank?

PROPOSED SUCCESS CRITERIA

- **Clearer understanding**
- **Confident next step**
- **Appropriate human support**

OUTPUT **One focused problem statement + one How Might We question + proposed success criteria.**

UNDERSTAND | EMPATHIZE | **DEFINE** | IDEATE | PROTOTYPE & TEST

Phase 4 - Ideate

DAY 3

We generated alternatives first, then selected a concept to prototype.

Idea space

We deliberately avoided jumping straight to AI.

We explored personalized learning, portfolio explanations, group education, goal-based reminders, advisor booking and an AI financial coach.

We combined ideas where they solved different parts of the same journey.

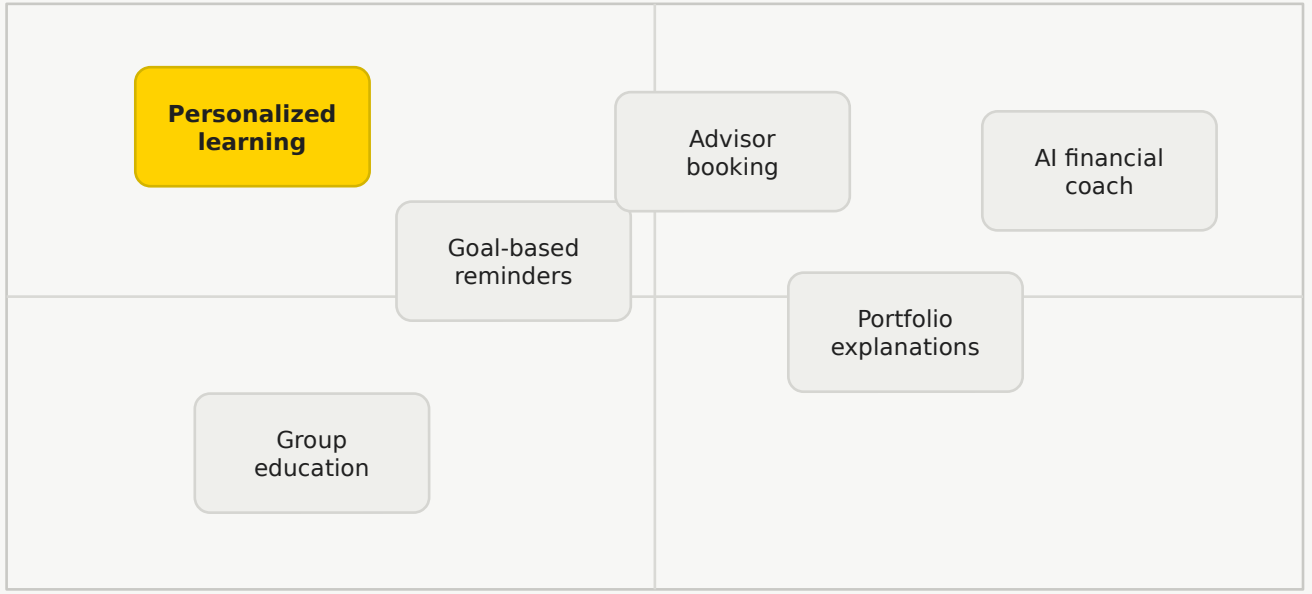
We compared them using customer relevance, likely impact, effort and regulatory complexity.

The matrix is an illustrative team judgment, not measured evidence.

We selected a hybrid concept because it could combine clarity, scale and human support.

ILLUSTRATIVE IMPACT vs EFFORT

HIGH IMPACT



Selected concept: personalized learning + contextual guidance + human escalation

OUTPUT **A selected concept + the assumptions it depends on.**

Phase 5 - Prototype and Test

DAY 4-5

We made the concept visible so people could react to a concrete experience.

What we prototyped

We created a low-fidelity banking-app flow plus a simple service workflow.

We used a hypothetical customer walkthrough to check the end-to-end logic.

We proposed a small formative test with target users rather than claiming validation.

We asked whether people understood the guidance, trusted the framing, could identify a suitable next step and knew when to request an advisor.

We captured confusion and hesitation as learning signals.

We revised wording, sequencing and escalation points based on hypothetical example feedback.

WHAT WE WOULD TEST

1. **Do customers understand the guidance?**
2. **Do they trust how it is framed?**
3. **Can they identify a suitable next step?**
4. **Do they know when to request an advisor?**

Hypothetical example feedback

“The difference between learning and a regulated recommendation is not clear enough.” -> Revise labels and advisor handoff.

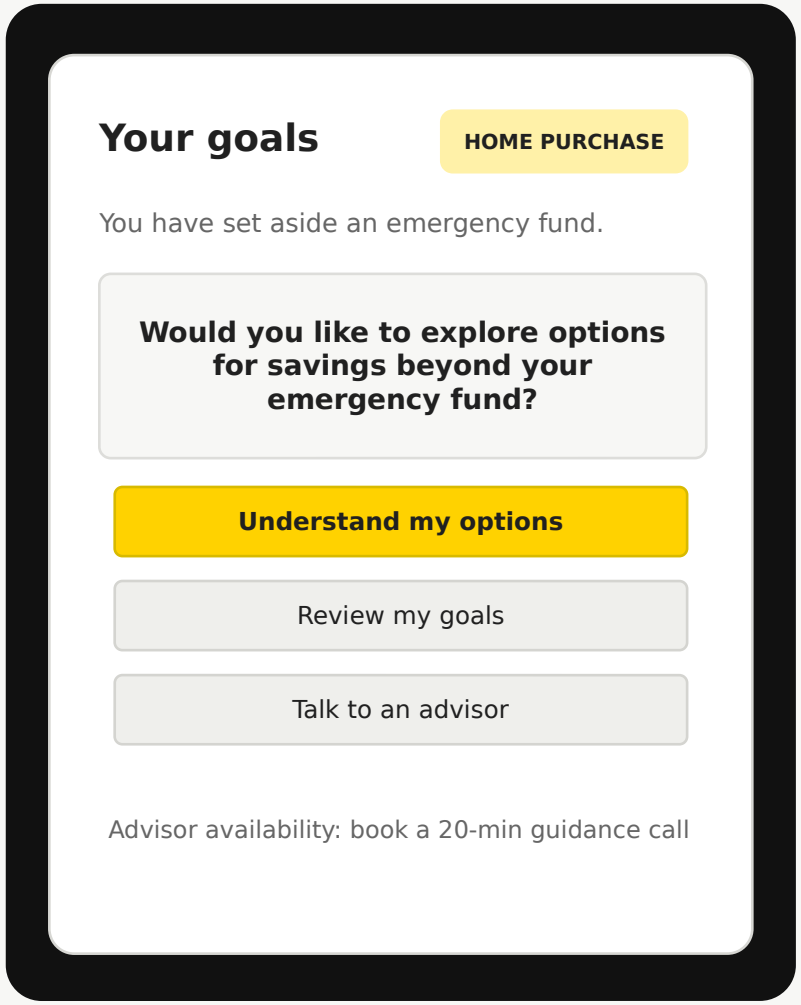
OUTPUT **Prototype + initial learning + revisions - not proof of business success.**

UNDERSTAND | EMPATHIZE | DEFINE | IDEATE | **PROTOTYPE & TEST**

Illustrative App Mockup

LOW-FIDELITY

A guided experience inside the banking app - education first, optional human support when needed.



SHORT LEARNING MODULE

Before comparing options

RISK	Value can rise or fall. Match risk with your goal and time horizon.
FEES	Fees reduce returns. Compare ongoing and one-off costs.
LIQUIDITY	Some products are easier to access than others. Keep near-term needs in mind.

Need personal advice? Book a qualified advisor Book advisor

Illustrative only. The app would not assume that cash should always be invested or present investments as automatically safe.

Service Blueprint

How a relevant signal could lead to optional education, goal clarification and qualified human support.

CUSTOMER ACTIONS	**Opens app** →	**Chooses to explore** →	**Reviews goal** →	**Learns** →	**Requests help**
VISIBLE INTERACTIONS	Optional prompt →	Guided questions →	Goal summary →	Education →	Advisor booking
BEHIND THE SCENES	Signal rules + consent →	Data permissions →	Suitability trigger →	Content controls →	Advisor routing

Guardrails: explicit consent and data permissions | suitability checks where required | qualified advisor involvement for regulated recommendations

Value and Next-Step Validation

The workshop gives us hypotheses to test - not a finished business case.

Expected customer value

Clarity about options
Confidence in the next step
Transparent explanation of risk, fees and liquidity
Access to support without unnecessary friction

Hypothesized bank value

Stronger engagement
Better continuity across digital and human channels
Potential retention benefits
Appropriate investment participation where suitable

Measures for a pilot

Comprehension
Task completion
Advisor demand
Customer trust
Cost to serve
Longer-term retention

KEY UNKNOWNS

- **Customer demand**
- **Advisor capacity**
- **Pricing**
- **Regulatory feasibility**
- **Commercial viability**

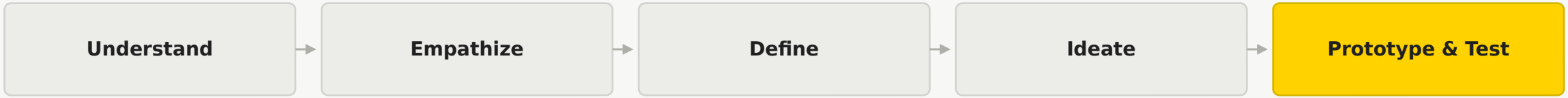
Recommended next step **Run a small pilot with clearly defined users, measures and regulatory guardrails before committing to a full business case or rollout.**

Final Pitch and Process Recap

What we would present at the end of the workshop.

“We help banks turn premium banking into a proactive financial-guidance journey: personalized learning for clarity, digital support for scale, and human advice when customers need it.”

OUR WORKSHOP PATH



Design thinking is iterative

Feedback can send us back to earlier phases to redefine the problem, gather better evidence or change the concept.

What the workshop actually produces

A testable concept and a validation plan - not a finished product and not a proven business plan.

Illustrative future scenario - research findings and test results are hypothetical.